

Investment in electronics manufacturing a key area of focus: Sibal



At a time when the country's import bill on electronics and semiconductors is at an all time high, to the point that they are threatening to become the highest value items on India's trade deficit list, the government has finally been jolted into taking notice of the situation.

According to a recently made announcement by Union Minister for Communications & Information Technology, Kapil Sibal, the Union government is set to officially urge states for supporting ongoing efforts of the government to ensure promotion of investment in electronics system design and manufacturing (ESDM) in India.

According to Sibal, the emphasis now is on the role that state governments will have to play in ensuring the creation of an environment that is geared towards the development of the industry. It will include steps like ensuring the availability of land, water, roads and training infrastructure to ensure industry has access to skilled manpower which can support manufacturing.

Tablet shipments reaching tipping point for Android to overtake Apple

Apple has been able to maintain its tablet lead by delivering a quality experience at

Vinod Sharma new ESC chairman

Electronics and Computer Software Export Promotion Council (ESC) has appointed Vinod Sharma, managing director at Deki Electronics, Noida, as the chairman for 2013-15.

Subroto Das new sales director, WD India

WD, a Western Digital company, announced that Subroto Das has joined the company as sales director, India, for its components and branded products businesses. Das is responsible for the sales-management and market-growth strategies of the Indian subcontinent.

a premium price. The iPad maker exited the first calendar quarter of 2013 with 50 per cent share of all tablet shipments, though, according to market intelligence firm ABI Research, the Android ecosystem is poised to overtake iOS.

The big variable for Android is China. The Middle Kingdom is passionate about the Apple brand as well as the masses' ability to afford technology devices. Smaller, 7-inch Android tablets have become popular though most lack the Google suite of apps and Android Play marketplace. A push for sub-\$200 tablets is keeping Android relevant in both developed and emerging markets.

"It's inevitable that Android tablets will overtake iOS-powered slates, though we see no single vendor challenging Apple's dominance anytime soon," says senior practice director Jeff Orr. "With media tablets commercially available for more than 4 years, momentum is shifting toward value and affordability, putting tablets in more of the population's reach."

Global touchscreen panel shipments to double by 2016

Worldwide shipments of touchscreen panels are set to double from 2012 to 2016, reaching nearly 3 billion units

In Focus

Lenovo appoints Sudhin Mathur as director-smartphones

Lenovo India has appointed Sudhin Mathur as director-smartphones for India. Based out of Gurgaon, Sudhin will be responsible for steering the company's aggressive growth strategies for smartphones in India.

Dell India names Alok Ohrie as president & MD

Dell has named Alok Ohrie as the president and MD, Dell India. Alok will carry the responsibility of further enhancing Dell's end-to-end solutions capabilities and expanding the company's strong presence.

as a wide variety of products beyond smartphones and tablets adopt the technology, particularly notebook PCs.

A total of 2.8 billion touch-screen panels will ship in 2016, up from 1.3 billion in 2012, according to the IHS DisplayBank 'Touch Panel Issue and Cost/Industry Analysis Report,' from information and analytics provider IHS. Shipments this year will surge 34 per cent to reach 1.8 billion units, as presented in the attached figure.

"Growth in the touchscreen market will be driven by increasing penetration in markets beyond the smartphone and tablet businesses," said Duke Yi, senior manager for display components and materials research at IHS. "Demand so far has largely been limited to these two markets. However, touchscreen sales are increasing dramatically across a broad range of products, particularly notebook PCs."

Yi addressed his remarks to a large audience at the SID/IHS Touch Gesture Motion Focus Conference recently. He presented 14 different products that all will see growth in penetration of touchscreen technology through the year 2016. In addition to smartphones, tablets, notebooks and PCs, Yi said opportunities exist in the markets for